

The free version displays a small Game Maker logo during the loading of the user's game, while the registered version allows the user to replace the Game Maker logo with their logo.

LOVE2D

LÖVE is an awesome framework you can use to make 2D game prototypes in Lua. It's free, open-source, and works on Windows, Mac OS X and Linux.

PROS:

- ▶ Utilizes the simplicity and power of scripting language Lua
- ▶ Freely available
- ▶ Good series of tutorials and demos to help you start with.
- ▶ Contains a lot of pre-written code targeted at making games.
- ▶ Its API (Application Programming Interface) is very simple.
- ▶ Friendly and supportive community.

CONS:

- ▶ Lacks a strong UI, drag -drop interface.
- ▶ Useful only if you can take effort to learn scripting.

Where can you get this?

- ▶ You can download Love Game engine from: <http://love2d.org/>
- ▶ You may need to download Lua if you haven't already from: <http://www.lua.org/download.html>

UNITY

Unity is one of the most powerful and accepted 3D game engine at present. You'll get lights, particle systems, collision, input controls, 3D world, cameras, PHYSICS engine and everything else you need to make your first 3D game prototype.

PROS:

- ▶ Free version gives you 95 per cent of the paid functionality forever.
- ▶ You can make complex 3d games you dream of with ease.
- ▶ Cross-Platform (PC/MAC/iPhone/Android/ Xbox/ Playstation/ Wii)
- ▶ Excellent documentation
- ▶ Powerful rendering, sound, physics engine and networking capabilities.
- ▶ 3 scripting languages: JavaScript, C#, and a dialect of Python called Boo
- ▶ Great tweaking and debugging support